



A file that needs to be locked away, an intriguing mark on the CPU, a motherboard that refuses to recognise hard disks... Here's the denouement to it all!

Q. Windows 98 to XP

I was unable to install Windows XP Professional in the MS-DOS mode. I had to install Windows 98 SE first, and then upgrade it to Windows XP Professional. Is there a way to install Windows XP Professional without having to follow this procedure?

Mahendra

A You can install Windows XP by executing the winnt.exe within the i386 folder on the Windows XP CD. The setup then asks for the path of the source files, and starts the installation. Another alternative is to install it directly using a Windows XP bootable CD. To change the boot sequence, re-start your PC and press [Del] (or [F2], or [F12], depending upon your motherboard) to enter the CMOS setup. Change the first boot option to CD-ROM and keep the hard disk as the second boot option. Now boot your PC using the Windows XP CD. The setup should start automatically.

Keep less work at startup

Q. I get a USERINIT.exe error, whenever I switch on my computer. The PC runs Windows XP Home edition.

Deepak Dugar

A This error occurs when Windows initialises the users environment. There exists a way by which you can start a

program even before Explorer starts. This feature is used by software such as Norton AntiVirus, McAfee, etc., to execute the program automatically.

To eliminate the error, you will need to change the settings in the anti-virus program so that no virus scan is initialised at startup. Restart your computer and the error should not occur again. If it persists, then another application may be causing the error. You will have to find the program that starts at startup, and disable it.

Upgrade to higher capacity drive

Q. I wish to upgrade my PC's BIOS to allow it to recognise large hard disks. I have a Pentium-III 266 MHz, 128 MB RAM, 4.3 GB hard disk, SG200A video card, 440LX motherboard, and the Award modular BIOS Version 4.1. I wish to have both Linux and Windows on this PC. My problem is that although I am keen on using a large hard disk, say 40 to 60 GB, my motherboard manual says it will not recognise hard disks beyond 8.4 GB. What I can do to solve this?

V.A. Kowshik

A This is a problem faced by many. There are three methods to solve this problem:

Update your motherboard's BIOS. Download the update available for your

motherboard model at the manufacturer's Web site, and follow the steps given at the site, to flash the BIOS. However, they may not be an update available for your motherboard, it being too old.

Get an add-on IDE controller. Purchase an IDE controller card, install the drivers, and connect it to the high capacity hard drive. Though being an expensive solution, it will surely solve your problem.

Use utilities provided by your drive manufacturer:

If you use a Maxtor hard drive, download the utility at http://www.maxtor.com/en/support/downloads/big_drive_enabler.htm

Seagate's utility is available at <http://www.seagate.com/support/kb/disc/capacity/index.html>



Maxtor's Big Drive Enabler provides support for larger hard drives